office work. Instead, he should be allowed the freedom to attend office as and when he could; that his priority was to run for the country.

As a result of that meeting, I was given accommodation in Chandigarh, and my office hours were relaxed. I was able to resume my morning and evening practice routine. Over time, I also began to get more involved with my sports development work and started enjoying creating projects that were close to my heart.

At the same time, I continued to participate in events in India as well as overseas. I was part of the Indian contingent for the Jakarta Asian Games in August 1962, where I won two gold medals, one for the 400-metre race and the other as part of the 4x400-metre relay team. And then it was on to the Olympics in Tokyo in 1964, after which I hung up my boots. My sports career finally set in 1964. A new chapter now awaited me.

Soon after retiring, I announced that I would give an award of two lakh rupees to any athlete who breaks my record of 45.6 seconds in the Olympics. So far, this has not happened, but I have stipulated that even, when I’m no more, my son Jeev will honour the award.